

defensive strategy. But in June 1863, Lee fatefully invaded Pennsylvania. At Gettysburg, the terrain was not in his favor and he was reduced to ordering futile frontal assaults, but he also made tactical errors. After Gettysburg, Lee tried to resign, but President Jefferson Davis could not spare him. Forced onto the defensive against Ulysses S. Grant in 1864 and 1865, he fought with tenacity and brilliance. When it became futile to continue, he surrendered with dignity.

After the war, Lee was excluded from the general amnesty. Arlington House had been confiscated and was not returned. When he died, many white Southerners idolized Lee's memory and his reputation continued to grow, feeding into the "Lost Cause" narrative that the Confederate defeat was purely due to its inferior resources.



Interior of Lee's field tent

Relics of Lee are treasured objects. Here his field tent is preserved with his boots, saddle, and hat, along with his mess chest, assorted plates, cutlery, and cooking utensils.